

THE LINEUP

Investor Overview

The digital booking marketplace for South African live music

Confidential · September 2026

1. Executive Summary

The LineUp is a marketplace platform that connects music artists with promoters and event organisers. It replaces fragmented WhatsApp chains, informal referrals, and unreliable handshake deals with a clear, professional flow: discover talent, request a booking, confirm terms, communicate in-app, and settle payment.

South Africa's live music economy—especially Amapiano, Afro-house, hip-hop, and gospel—is growing fast, but the tools used to book talent have not kept up. The LineUp sits in that gap: a trusted digital layer between supply (artists) and demand (promoters), with subscription access as the core revenue engine and transaction and value-added services as expansion levers.

2. The Problem

- Promoters struggle to find verified artists, compare rates, and manage multiple bookings in one place.
- Artists lose gigs to poor coordination, unpaid deposits, and lack of a professional booking presence online.
- Most deals still live in chat threads—no shared status, no audit trail, weak payment discipline.
- There is no dominant, trusted SA marketplace purpose-built for live performance bookings.

3. The Solution — How The LineUp Works

The LineUp is a two-sided platform:

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- **Artists create profiles** — stage name, genre, location, rate, bio, and media — and receive booking requests.
- **Promoters browse and filter** the catalogue, request dates, and manage responses in one dashboard.
- **Bookings move through clear statuses** — pending, confirmed, declined, paid — so both sides know where they stand.
- **In-app messaging** keeps negotiation and logistics tied to the booking, not scattered across personal chats.
- **Payment flows** (including local options such as PayFast) support deposits and full settlement with status tracking.

The product is already live as a working application (React frontend, API backend, Postgres via Supabase, deployed on modern cloud infrastructure), with a seeded South African artist catalogue and demo flows for both artist and promoter roles.

4. Market Opportunity

Live entertainment and nightlife in South Africa remain resilient demand categories. Amapiano in particular has become a global export, driving festival line-ups, club residencies, corporate events, and private functions. Booking activity is high-frequency and relationship-driven—exactly the kind of market that benefits from a neutral, searchable, always-on platform.

- Large base of independent artists and DJs who need discovery and professional booking tools.
- Promoters, venues, corporates, and student organisations that book repeatedly and need reliability.
- Underserved by global generic tools that ignore local payment, language, and genre context.

5. How We Make Money

5.1 Core model — Subscriptions

Access to The LineUp is gated by paid subscription plans for both sides of the marketplace. Free browsing or limited trials may exist for acquisition, but sustained use—full catalogue access, unlimited booking requests, messaging, and dashboard tools—requires a subscription.

Plan	Who it is for	Indicative monthly	What they get
Artist Starter	Emerging artists	R99 – R149	Profile, limited requests, basic inbox
Artist Pro	Working performers	R249 – R399	Full visibility, unlimited requests, priority ranking
Promoter Starter	Occasional bookers	R199 – R299	Browse, limited active bookings
Promoter Business	Agencies & venues	R499 – R899	Unlimited bookings, team seats, analytics

Note: Price bands are directional for investor discussion and will be validated with early users. Annual plans with a discount improve cash collection and retention.

Why subscriptions first: predictable recurring revenue (MRR), alignment with ongoing platform value (catalogue + tools), and lower friction than taking a cut of every small deal while the market is still being educated.

5.2 Additional revenue streams

- **Booking / success fees** — Optional percentage or flat fee when a booking is confirmed or paid (e.g. 5–10% of fee, or a fixed success fee). Can be introduced after trust is established.
- **Featured placement** — Artists or agencies pay to appear higher in search, on the home page, or in genre collections (“Featured this weekend”).
- **Verified badges** — Paid identity and performance verification (ID, social proof, past-gig references) that increases promoter confidence.

- **Payment facilitation margin** — Where deposits and balances flow through the platform (PayFast and later other rails), a small convenience or processing margin.
- **Premium messaging & CRM** — Advanced inbox, templates, auto-reminders, and promoter CRM for agencies managing many artists.
- **Data & insights (later)** — Anonymised demand reports for venues, labels, and brands (“which genres book most in Gauteng this quarter”).
- **Brand & sponsorship** — Sponsored collections, festival partners, and brand campaigns targeting the live-music audience on the platform.

6. Expanding the Business Model

Beyond the core marketplace, The LineUp can grow into a broader live-entertainment operating system:

- **Geographic expansion** — Replicate the model across African markets with strong live scenes (Nigeria, Kenya, Ghana) and diaspora event markets.
- **Venue and festival tools** — Venue profiles, calendar holds, multi-artist line-up builders, and festival submission workflows.
- **Contracts & compliance** — Digital booking agreements, deposit rules, cancellation policies, and simple dispute workflows.
- **Talent management SaaS** — White-label or multi-artist dashboards for managers and agencies who represent rosters.
- **Ticketing adjacency** — Partnerships or light integration with ticketing providers so confirmed bookings connect to on-sale events.
- **Education & community** — Paid workshops, creator programmes, and community events that deepen retention and brand.
- **Merchandise & fan commerce (long term)** — Optional storefronts for artists once traffic and trust justify it.
- **API / B2B distribution** — Let venues, campus apps, and event platforms pull availability or request bookings via API.

7. Why This Can Win

- Category focus: live performance bookings in SA genres—not a generic freelance marketplace.
- Two-sided liquidity plan: seed strong artist catalogue, then activate promoters with clear ROI.
- Local rails: SA payments, mobile-first UX, pricing in Rand, genre taxonomy that locals recognise.
- Workflow depth: statused bookings, messaging, and payment state beat ad-hoc chat.
- Subscription base: recurring revenue while network effects compound.

8. Product Status (Traction Snapshot)

- Full-stack product live: web app for artists and promoters.
- Artist catalogue seeded (including major SA Amapiano and related acts for demonstration).
- Auth, bookings, messaging, and payment hooks implemented.
- Cloud deployment (frontend + API) with managed Postgres.

- Next commercial focus: convert early users to paid plans, tighten activation loops, and measure booking completion.

9. Indicative Use of Investment

Capital would primarily accelerate:

- Customer acquisition — promoter outreach, artist onboarding campaigns, campus and venue partnerships.
- Product — mobile polish, subscription billing, ranking/search quality, reliability at scale.
- Trust & operations — verification, support, and dispute playbooks.
- Team — focused hires in growth, engineering, and partnerships.

10. Closing

The LineUp turns a messy, high-volume offline behaviour—booking artists—into a structured digital marketplace. Subscriptions from artists and promoters create a clear path to recurring revenue; success fees, featured placement, verification, and adjacent services expand the model as liquidity grows.

We are building the default place where South African talent gets on the bill—and where promoters book with confidence.

Contact

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